

Tribal Mart

Portal flow & interaction architecture

A four-portal marketplace connecting India's tribal artisan cooperatives with conscious buyers — featuring an Agent-assisted listing workflow and an instant Hindi/English language switch for the people who actually craft the goods sold here.

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01 — The four portals

One platform, four distinct roles.

Most marketplaces have two sides — buyer and seller. Tribal Mart introduces a third: an Agent who can list and manage products on behalf of artisans who may not be comfortable with digital tools. This bridges a real-world gap for older tribal craftspeople — their craft reaches the world while the digital work is handled with their consent.

■ Customer

Anyone buying authentic tribal craft.

- Browse, search, filter by category / price
- Cart (multi-item) + saved addresses + payment methods
- Order tracking timeline with cancel + reorder + invoice
- Reviews after delivery; returns within 7 days
- Watchlist, Compare (up to 4 products), Profile

■ Agency

Tribal cooperatives and studios — the sellers.

- Add / edit / duplicate / delete products
- Fulfil orders: confirm → process → ship + tracking + packing slip
- Returns review, payouts dashboard, analytics
- Hindi ■ English instant toggle across the portal
- Request agent help when digital work is too much

■ Agent

Digital helpers for tribal cooperatives.

- See incoming agency help requests, approve to manage
- List products on behalf of managed cooperatives
- Drill into per-agency stats, orders, and listings
- Earn 5% commission on every approved sale of their listings
- Step down from an agency anytime

■■■Admin

Platform stewards keeping the marketplace honest.

- Approve / reject listings (single or bulk) + verify KYC docs
- Manage users (suspend / activate / detail view)
- Curate featured products, manage categories
- Financial dashboard: GMV, commission, GST, payable
- Settle payouts to cooperatives + view audit trail

02 — Customer flow

From discovery to delivery to review.

1

Sign up / log in

Pick the Customer portal from the 4-card chooser. Sign up with name + email + password; log-in routes to /dashboard/customer.

2

Browse & search

Filter by category, price range, or keyword. Search hits /api/products/all?search=...

3

Product detail

View images, price, condition, agency name (with verified badge if their docs are approved), and reviews. Click agency name → opens their public store.

4

Cart / Buy now

Add to cart (multi-item) OR Buy Now directly. The cart auto-loads on /cart.

5

Checkout

Saved addresses pre-fill automatically. Pick payment: COD or Razorpay online. Order placed → cart cleared, redirect to /orders.

6

Track order

Status timeline: placed → confirmed → processing → shipped → delivered. Customer can cancel before shipping; download invoice anytime.

7

Review

After delivery, write a star rating + comment from /product/:id. Shows on the product page for future buyers.

8

Return (within 7 days)

Optional. Customer opens a return with reason; goes to /returns. Agency approves → marks refunded once the return is shipped back.

9

Reorder

One click on any past order's modal refills the cart with the same items.

03 — Agency flow

List, fulfil, earn — in Hindi or English.

1 Sign up

Agency creates account → uploads verification documents (Business License, Tax Certificate, Authorization Letter).

2 Document approval

Admin reviews → on approval, agency earns a Verified Cooperative badge displayed on their listings and storefront.

3 Add product

Title, description, category, original/selling price, quantity, condition, images. Status starts as 'pending'.

4 Request agent help (optional)

From dashboard quick action → browse agents → send a request with agency address. Agent decides to accept or decline.

5 Manage listings

My Products: filter by status, edit, duplicate, delete, low-stock pill when qty ≤ 3, preview as a customer.

6 Fulfil orders

Agency Orders: see incoming orders, mark Confirmed → Processing → Shipped (add tracking note) → Delivered. Print a packing slip with barcode.

7 Handle returns

Customer-initiated returns appear under /returns. Approve, receive item, mark Refunded.

8 Analytics & payouts

Real-time stats on revenue, conversion, top categories. Payouts page shows gross sales → 10% commission → 18% GST → net payable, with weekly settlement schedule.

9 Hindi mode

EN/■■■ toggle in the dashboard hero swaps the entire portal — sidebar, stats, actions, all instantly translated.

04 — Agent flow

Helping artisans go digital — and earning while doing it.

1

Sign up

Pick Agent portal → sign up with name + email + password + address. Address is shown to agencies considering their help.

2

Receive agency requests

Dashboard shows incoming help requests from agencies. Each request includes the agency's name, address, and how long they've been waiting.

3

Approve / reject

Approve → agency moves to your Managed Agencies. Reject (with reason) → agency is notified to find another agent.

4

List products for them

From dashboard, click 'List for them' on an agency row — opens AddProduct with the agency pre-selected. Product status starts at 'pending_agency_approval'.

5

Agency reviews

The agency sees the agent-listed product in their dashboard with Approve/Reject buttons. On approval, status → 'pending' (admin queue). On rejection, status → 'rejected_by_agency'.

6

Edit / delete own listings

Agent can modify or remove only listings they uploaded — never the agency's own listings.

7

Per-agency drill-down

Click any managed agency to see their catalogue, orders, and stats — plus your own contribution (products listed, sold, live).

8

Track earnings

Agent Earnings page: 5% commission on every approved sale of products the agent uploaded. Per-agency breakdown showing productsListed / sold / live / revenue / commission.

9

Step down

Any agent can step down from an agency from the drilldown page. Agency becomes available for another agent.

05 — Admin flow

Stewardship: approve, verify, settle, audit.

1

Dashboard

Live counts of total products, pending approvals, approved live, total users. Quick-action cards for the four most common admin tasks.

2

Pending product queue

Review each pending listing: image, title, description, price, agency. Approve, reject (with reason), or use checkboxes to bulk approve / reject.

3

Document approval

Inline preview of uploaded KYC documents (Business License, Tax Certificate, Authorization Letter). Approve to verify the agency — they get a Verified badge.

4

User management

List of all users grouped by role. Click any user to view detail: their orders, products, messages, agent relations. Suspend / activate / delete from the table.

5

Featured products

On the All Products page, click ■ on any approved product to mark it as Featured. Featured listings appear in the landing-page 'Handpicked this week' section.

6

Categories

Add or remove product categories. Reflected in agency Add Product dropdown and customer browse filters.

7

Analytics

Platform-wide metrics: orders, GMV, conversion, top categories, top agencies, monthly trend.

8

Financial dashboard

GMV → 10% commission → 18% GST → payable to cooperatives. Per-agency settlement table with Mark Paid buttons. Tracks platform revenue.

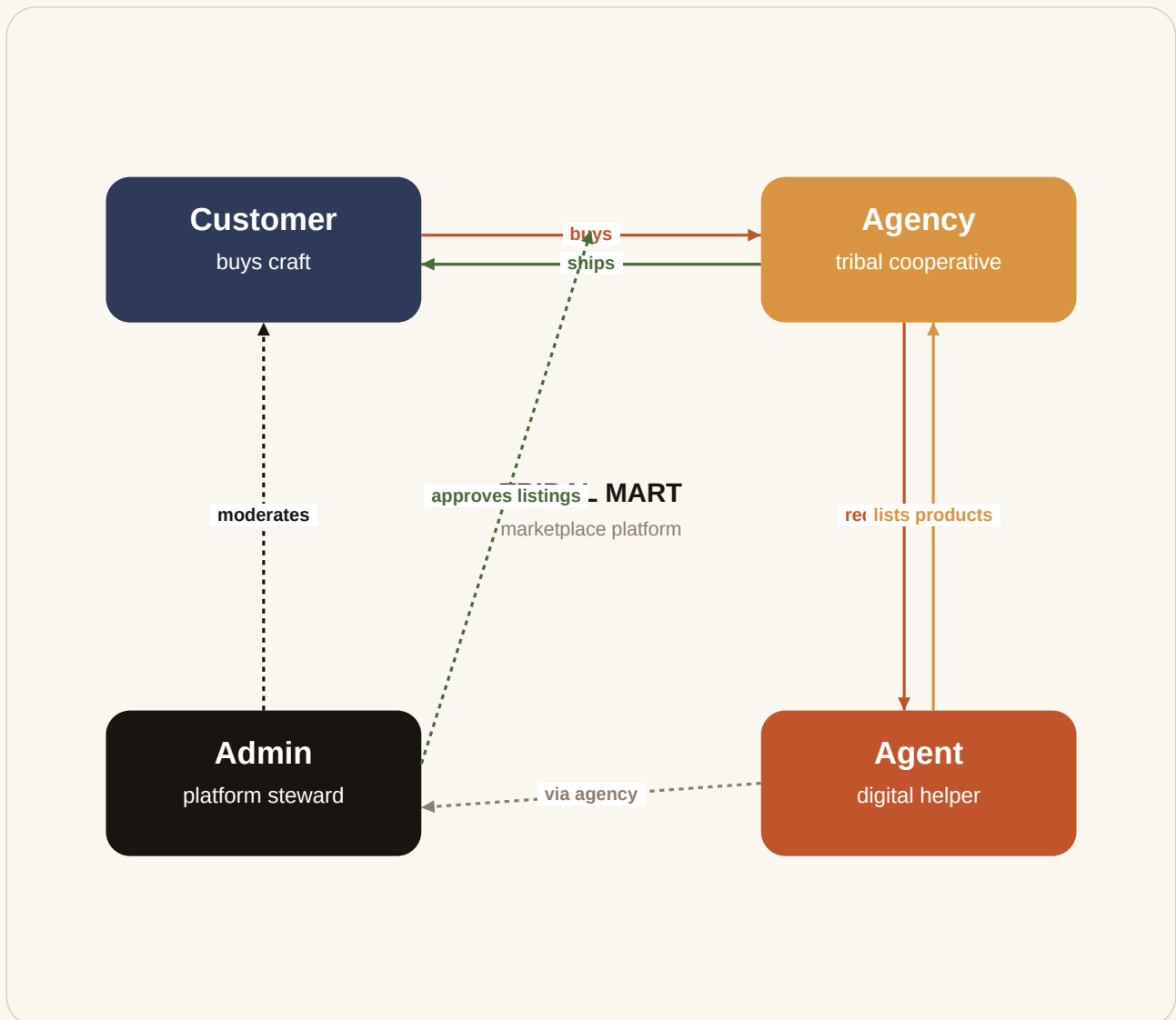
9

Settle payouts

Click Mark Paid on each settlement row — agency gets credited via UPI / bank transfer (out-of-band in v1).

06 — Cross-portal interaction map

How the four panels talk to each other.



Solid arrows = direct human-initiated actions. Dashed arrows = moderation / oversight by Admin. Two-way arrows where each role responds to the other.

The full lifecycle of an agent-listed product



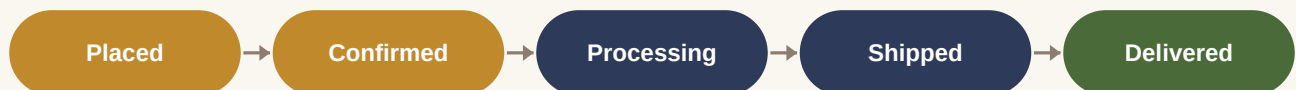
Each transition emits the next state on the Product document. Every actor can only act on states they're allowed to — guarded by role middleware and ownership checks on the backend.

07 — Product status state machine

Every state, every actor, every transition.

Status	Who can set it	Description
pending_agency_approval	Agent	Newly listed by an agent — awaiting the agency's nod.
pending	Agency · Admin	Agency-approved or agency-created; awaiting admin.
approved	Admin	Live on the marketplace; visible to customers.
rejected	Admin	Admin declined — agency sees the rejection reason.
rejected_by_agency	Agency	Agency declined an agent's submission.
sold	Order system	Inventory depleted via a customer purchase.

08 — Order lifecycle



Each status change is timestamped and pushed into the order's **trackingUpdates** array. The customer sees the timeline live on their Orders page; the agency triggers each transition from their Order detail modal.

09 — Return / refund flow



Initiated by the customer on a delivered order. The owning agency reviews, approves, receives the physical return, and marks it refunded. Every transition appends to the return's timeline and notifies the relevant party.

10 — Data model & API

What's stored, what's exposed.

Core models

Model	Notable fields
User	name, email, password, role (agency / customer / admin / agent), address, addresses[], paymentMethods[], avatarUrl, age
Product	title, description, category, originalPrice, sellingPrice, quantity, condition, images[], agency (ref), agencyName, uploadedB
Order	orderNumber, customer (ref), customerName, agency (ref), items[], shippingAddress, totalAmount, paymentMethod, paym
Cart	customer (ref), items[{ product, quantity, addedAt }] (computed totals on read)
Wishlist	customer (ref), items[product (ref)]
Document	agency (ref), businessLicense, taxCertificate, authorizationLetter, status, reviewedAt
AgentRequest	agency (ref), agent (ref), agencyName, agencyAddress, status (pending/approved/rejected), rejectionReason
Review	product (ref), customer (ref), customerName, rating (1-5), comment (max 1000 chars)
Return	order (ref), customer (ref), agency (ref), items[], reason, status, refundAmount, timeline[]
Sale	agency (ref), amount, createdAt (used for sales analytics)
Message	from (ref), to (ref), subject, body, threadId

API surface (high-level)

Group	Sample routes
Auth (public)	POST /api/auth/register · POST /api/auth/login
Products (public)	GET /api/products/all (search, filters) · GET /:id · GET /store/:agencyId · GET /featured/list
Reviews (public)	GET /api/reviews/:productId
Customer	/api/customer/cart · /api/customer/wishlist · /api/orders · /api/profile/addresses · /api/profi
Agency	POST /api/products · /api/products/agent-uploads-pending · /api/orders/agency-orders · /api/age
Agent	/api/agents/requests/incoming · /api/agents/managed-agencies · /api/agents/earnings · POST /api
Admin	/api/admin/dashboard-stats · /api/admin/pending-products · /api/admin/all-products · /api/admin

11 — Demo accounts & quick-start

Everything you need to run the live demo.

Demo accounts

Role	Email	Password
Admin	admin@setu.com	admin123
Agency (with managing agent)	agency@demo.com	demo123
Agency (no agent)	santhal@demo.com	demo123
Agent (manages Bhil agency)	agent@demo.com	demo123
Customer (has reviews)	customer@demo.com	demo123
Customer 2	rohan@demo.com	demo123

Run locally

```
git clone <repo> tribal-mart
cd tribal-mart
cd backend && npm install && cp .env.example .env
# fill MONGO_URI and JWT_SECRET in backend/.env
node scripts/seedAdmin.js && node scripts/seedDemo.js
npm start

# in another terminal
cd frontend && npm install && cp .env.example .env
npm run dev
# open http://localhost:3000
```

Suggested demo flow (60 seconds)

#	Action
1	Land on / → hover the card stack, scroll past Hero / Makers / Stats.
2	Click Sign Up → see the 4-portal selector → click Agent → split-card slides.
3	Log in as customer@demo.com → tour dashboard → Browse → Add to Cart → Checkout.

4	Log in as agency@demo.com → click EN/■■■■ toggle — entire UI flips to Hindi.
5	Open My Products → ■ Duplicate. Orders → mark Shipped → print Packing Slip.
6	Open Payouts — see GMV → commission → GST → net payable.
7	Log in as agent@demo.com → see incoming requests → drill into a managed agency.
8	Log in as admin@setu.com → Pending Products → check 3 → Bulk Approve. Finance → settle. Categories → add 'Pottery'.

Made with care for India's tribal artisan communities — Bhil, Santhal, Munda, Toda, Gond, and many others — whose craft deserves a marketplace that respects their pace, their language, and their dignity.